

Kashif Nazir

Senior Technical Architect

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Senior Technical Architect at Cloudhouse since September 2025, having joined the company in March 2019. IT career began at St John Ambulance in February 2015, followed by Aspen Insurance/Cognizant and progression through professional services, technical management and architecture to product council. Runs the cross-team R&D function on a daily basis and has led both of the company's enterprise AI evaluation programmes. The through-line is architecture with proof attached: shape the design at the council table and run the proof-of-concept that tests it the same week.

The recurring problem across the last year has been verification: knowing whether a model output is correct, and building the harness that shows it. Code is AI-assisted; the evaluation method, the guardrails, and the validation are mine.

Technical environment: Model Context Protocol, agent orchestration, evaluation harnesses, and RAG-style retrieval. Python (AI-assisted), PowerShell, Kotlin. AWS, Azure, GCP, Cloudflare Workers and D1, VMware, Docker. Terraform, Packer, Ansible. Jira, Confluence, GitHub.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Technical Architect, Cloudhouse Technologies

September 2025 to present

Architecture direction across three product lines, with a seat on the product councils alongside senior leadership, and daily operational lead of the company's cross-team R&D function.

- Leads the enterprise AI programme end to end: an eight-person evaluation, a side-by-side vendor comparison, the cost model behind the business case, and a governed company-wide adoption decision, now scaled into production automation across engineering, professional services, and customer-facing workflows.
- Authors and delivers the company's AI training and enablement, including the onboarding model used as adoption extends into further business functions.
- Turns proofs of concept into product through a continuous delivery cycle. A recent proof built jointly with engineering became an early-stage offering for deploying Windows applications into AWS WorkSpaces.
- Designed and built an MCP server integrating a configuration-monitoring product with an enterprise change-management system, closing a loop that had been three manual questions: was this the change we intended, did anything unexpected come with it, does the result meet policy. Roughly ninefold less data pulled into model context across payload-heavy calls. Code AI-assisted; the specification, guardrails, and validation are mine.
- Hardened that integration for how it breaks in someone else's hands: advisory never autonomous, write actions off by default behind a four-layer harness of restricted-role credentials, human confirmation and a preview-to-apply token, and silent failure on a lost network path replaced with four explicit degraded-but-alive states. A non-developer installed it as a desktop extension and drove real change requests through independently.
- Runs the company's cross-team R&D function on a daily basis, having designed the operating model that governs it: the intake-to-graduation lifecycle, the skills matrix used to assign work across specialists, and a Slack-to-Jira intake workflow with AI-assisted triage.
- Gave the whole company a retrospective on the R&D function's first year: 20 items passed to engineering, most of them as lessons and prototypes, and every recent graduation handed to a named owner, from the professional-services team now running the packaging rig to product engineering.
- Built a packaging intelligence and testing rig that reconstructs why an application behaves as it does from sources that disagree, and leaves a checkable record of the reasoning, halting cleanly instead of shipping a bad package. Resolved a live customer issue on it without consuming developer or professional-services time, then handed it to the delivery team to run self-serve.
- Built a mobile companion app for the configuration-monitoring product on Android and iOS, with live sign-in, drift approval and a node onboarded and scanned from the phone, then parked it at parity with no team yet to own its maintenance. Code AI-assisted; the specification, parity contract and live testing are mine.
- Assessed a third-party discovery tool for embedding behind the product in three evidence-graded write-ups for the head of product, setting out connector gaps, licensing cost risks and a six-to-nine-week integration estimate, and recommending vulnerability enrichment as the first step, already proven on the test estate.

Technical Manager, Cloudhouse Technologies

February 2020 to September 2025

- Led the technical side of the Professional Services function across on-premises and cloud migrations on AWS, Azure and VMware, specialising in multi-tier legacy workload remediation, with full line-management responsibility for the team and structured training and mentoring that doubled the team's certification count.
- Ran the company's first AI evaluation programme, piloting Microsoft 365 Copilot in 2024 when Microsoft opened it to smaller businesses, reaching full adoption within the technical team and company-wide use at varying levels of Copilot integration. Identified limitations in the tooling's usefulness while securing executive backing for wider AI integration. The current programme is the second instance of the same pattern.

Technical Manager, Cloudhouse Technologies (continued)

- Led the design of an AWS pipeline that automated server-workload packaging so it ran unattended, with design input from the AWS solutions architect and the head of engineering and the team building it out under my management, removing manual packaging effort from migrations.
- Standardised the team's packaging and migration workflows and built reusable migration templates adopted on later projects, cutting average migration timelines by 30 to 40%.
- Parachuted into a stalled Windows Server 2022 migration on-site in Canada for five weeks: completed the development and pre-production phases and bridged the UK and Canadian teams across time zones into production.

Earlier roles

February 2015 to February 2020

Professional Services Consultant at Cloudhouse (2019 to 2020): packaged and remediated Windows desktop, server and legacy web applications for deployment across AWS, Azure, GCP, Citrix, SCCM and App-V. Before that, service desk and second-line support at Aspen Insurance Group (2016 to 2019, via Cognizant after TUPE) and St John Ambulance (2015 to 2016): ITIL incident and change control, SCCM imaging and application packaging, and Active Directory, Exchange and Office 365 administration.

PROJECTS

Personal, built outside work. Code AI-assisted throughout; the system design, the verification gates, and the integration decisions are mine.

Outage Desk outage-desk.kashifnazir.com · github.com/thekashifnazir/outage-desk

An early prototype from a two-hour solo build at the GPT-6 Astra Hackathon in London. It turns outage reports into claims labelled by certainty, with fixed rules capping each label the model proposes by who said it, then drafts updates in which every sentence cites its claim.

SurfDeck surfdeck.kashifnazir.com · github.com/thekashifnazir/surfdeck

A discovery engine for the independent web, built spec-driven in Kiro across seven specs with agent hooks and every step human-gated. React and Hono on a single Cloudflare Worker over D1, three runtime dependencies, no runtime secrets. 404 tests across 27 files including property-based tests over the ranking engine, against a 349-row curated corpus. Repository and the full specification trail are public.

Moveset moveset.kashifnazir.com

A training log reachable three ways from one dataset: a React web app, a command-line tool, and a custom MCP server that lets Claude write structured sessions straight into it. Two Cloudflare Workers over a shared D1 database, WorkOS authentication verifying JWTs against AuthKit JWKS with read and write scopes, single-owner migrations, and a deploy token scoped never to run on pull requests. Sign-ups closed; the site is public and the repository is private.

An evaluation harness for AI writing feedback *repository private*

Built over a weekend as an independent two-part system: a lab that generates an editorial comment, applies it with a second model, and scores draft and revision on a rubric with a held-out judge, and an add-in that inserts a comment only once it passes the same gate. Validated each judge against a hand-labelled golden set using Cohen's kappa before trusting its scores, then used the harness to surface that models fabricate supporting evidence under pressure. A four-run stability pass narrowed the cost finding: cheaper judges were good enough on the task, and the priciest model was consistently weakest.

Step Out stepout.kashifnazir.com

Designed and built solo at a public AI hackathon in London inside a three-hour window, and shown working to attendees and the organiser: describe a situation in plain words, get local opportunities back with a reason for each. Directed roughly 29 parallel build streams, each with its own branch, worktree, and written brief, to 28 features stamped with a verified commit hash and no merge conflicts. Prompt iterated to v2.2 through a 40-check eval harness and a 14-sentence live battery, then frozen as a priced decision.

PitchPace *in build, not released*

A breath-pacing Android app in Kotlin, with Silero VAD bundled as ONNX in the APK and a line-for-line port of a Python scoring engine kept alongside as the reference check. 95 unit tests, and every merge builds a signed APK.

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Professional (recertified June 2026, continuously certified since 2020) · AWS Certified AI Practitioner · AWS Certified AI Business Strategist (Early Adopter) · AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate · AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner · Microsoft Certified: Azure AI Fundamentals · Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals · ITIL Foundation · CompTIA A+ and Network+

WRITING

By-lines published through the company's PR channel in TechRadar Pro, Information Security Buzz, and Networking+, alongside a separate personal stream at kashifnazir.com.

EDUCATION

BA (Hons) International Business Management, Coventry University, 2:1. Second year at Missouri State University on the Magellan Exchange.